

Jan Pfänder

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Positions

Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology (Eawag) Postdoctoral researcher • Advisor: Viktoria Cologna	Zurich, Switzerland Sep 2025 - present
Cambridge University Visiting Researcher • Host: Sander van der Linden	Cambridge, UK Mai 2026 - Jun 2026

Education

PhD École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Institut Jean Nicod, Psychology • Supervisors: Hugo Mercier & Kevin Arceneaux • Thesis: Essays on Understanding Trust in Science	Paris, France 2022 - 2025
MA École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Cognitive Science • Supervisor: Hugo Mercier • Thesis: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other?	Paris, France 2020 - 2022
MA Universität Freiburg, Journalism (1st year)	Freiburg, Germany 2019 - 2020
BA Universität Konstanz, Political Science and Public Administration	Konstanz, Germany 2014 - 2018

Work Experience

Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP) Research Intern	Paris, France Jun 2021 - Aug 2021
Assemblée Nationale Parliamentary Assistant	Paris, France Sep 2018 - Jul 2019
University of St. Gallen Research Assistant	St. Gallen, Switzerland Jun 2017 - Jul 2018

Publications

Peer-reviewed publications
(n = 5)

Global Studies on Trust in Science Suggest New Theoretical and Methodological Directions J. Pfänder, N. G. Mede, V. Cologna https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102215 (Current Opinion in Psychology)	2026
How Wise Is the Crowd: Can We Infer People Are Accurate and Competent Merely Because They Agree with Each Other? J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2024.106005 (Cognition)	2025
Quasi-Universal Acceptance of Basic Science in the United States J. Pfänder, L. Kerzreho, H. Mercier https://doi.org/10.1177/09636625251364407 (Public Understanding of Science)	2025
Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of News Judgements J. Pfänder, S. Altay https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02086-1 (Nature Human Behaviour)	2025
Trusting But Forgetting Impressive Science	2025

J. Pfänder, S. de Rouilhan, H. Mercier
<https://doi.org/10.1163/15685373-12340227> (Journal of Cognition and Culture)

Conference proceedings
(*n* = 1)

How Wise Is the Crowd: Can We Infer People Are Accurate and Competent Merely Because They Agree with Each Other? 2024
J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier
(Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society)

Large collaborations (minor role)
(*n* = 3)

Investigating the Analytical Robustness of the Social and Behavioural Sciences 2026
B. Aczel, B. Szaszi, H. T. Clelland, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-025-09844-9> (Nature)

Trust in Scientists and Their Role in Society across 68 Countries 2025
V. Cologna, N. G. Mede, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02090-5> (Nature Human Behaviour)

Perceptions of Science, Science Communication, and Climate Change Attitudes in 68 Countries – the TISP Dataset 2025
N. G. Mede, V. Cologna, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04100-7> (Scientific Data)

Working papers
(*n* = 2)

Sciences Perceived as Precise and Consensual Are More Trusted 2026
J. Pfänder, H. Mercier
https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/k9m6e_v3

The Rational Impression Account of Trust in Science 2025
J. Pfänder, H. Mercier
https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/nwka2_v1

Presentations

Invited talks

Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US – A Megastudy Approach 2026
Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin

Trust in science 2025
Paris School of International Affairs (Sciences Po), Paris

Conference presentations

Trusting but forgetting impressive science 2026
EASP General Meeting, Strasbourg

Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US – A Megastudy Approach 2026
EASP Small Meeting, Hohenheim

Predicting the effects of a megastudy with behavioral clones 2026
Behavioral Clones Workshop (Max Planck Institute for Human Development), Berlin

Belief in & interventions against misinformation 2025
15th Annual Conference of the European Political Science Association, Madrid

The rational impression account of trust in science 2025
Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, Paris

Spotting False News and Doubting True News. A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments (Keynote) 2025
Infox sur Seine, Paris

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? (Poster) 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam	2024
Processus sous-tendant la confiance dans la science 5ème édition des Rencontres Jeunes Chercheur·euse·s, Grenoble	2024
Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments EDMO Scientific Conference on Disinformation, Amsterdam	2024

Teaching

Courses

Fact-Checking and Critical Thinking Université PSL (Paris Sciences & Lettres) – BA program "Sciences pour un monde durable" • A hands-on introduction to research design for an interdisciplinary BA program • Sole instructor & creator of the course • 30h in-class per semester; one semester a year	2022 – 2025
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Workshops

Meta-analysis for beginners Laboratoire de Psychologie du Développement et de l'Éducation de l'Enfant (LaPsyDÉ)	2024
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Advising

Graduate students

- Lou Kerzreho (2023)

Undergraduate students

- Mateo Pivert (2024)
- Ludivine Million (2024)
- Prune Lefevre Jachimowicz (2024)
- Kevin Chen (2023)
- Théodore Lellouche (2022)

Professional Service

Peer Reviewing

(*n* = 10)

- Journals: *Nature Climate Change* (1), *Public Understanding of Science* (3), *PNAS Nexus* (1), *Social Science & Medicine* (1), *Društvena istraživanja* (1), *Behavior Research Methods* (1), *Educational Research Review* (1), *Artificial Intelligence Review* (1)

Summer Schools

Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute Hosted by the University of St. Andrews, organized by Indiana University Bloomington	St. Andrews, UK 2024
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Skills

Languages: German, English, French, Spanish

Programming: R, Git (basics), Python (rudimentary)